

EVERYDAY MILLIONAIRE

Will—a millionaire from Chicago—grew up in a blue-collar family and always watched his parents struggle with money. Seeing their constant money stress pushed Will to pursue financial independence for himself when he graduated college. He started out as a history teacher, but when he saw that accounting offered a more likely path to his financial goals, he went back to school to earn an accounting degree. He took an accounting job when he graduated, and he stayed with that same company for thirty-one years, eventually working his way up to the chief financial officer position. He married early in his career, and he and his wife, Holly, shared the goal of complete financial independence. Throughout their marriage, they lived frugally and drove older cars despite good incomes. They also prioritized saving and investing in their 401(k)s and other investments.

As the 401(k) plan administrator for his company, Will saw how other employees failed to take advantage of the simple wealth-building tools at their disposal. He knew everyone's salary, and he was shocked and saddened to see that they weren't investing much, if anything, into the company 401(k)—despite the generous company match. "People would rather spend money than save money," he says. That, plus the instant-gratification mentality he sees all around him, is why he thinks most people don't hit the millionaire mark. By avoiding these traps and keeping their long-term goals in mind, Will and Holly are now enjoying their dream retirement with a net worth of nearly \$4.5 million—something his parents couldn't have imagined.
